Prompt 1:

Are these reviews positive or negative?

Response 1:

The reviews are evenly split, with no clear lean either way. I read all 110 and classified each by hand:

Sentiment	Count	Share
Positive	41	37%
Negative	40	36%
Mixed	14	13%
Neutral or questions	15	14%

Sarcasm. Nine reviews sound positive on the surface but are negative (e.g. R022, R030, R066, R108). A basic sentiment tool would likely count these as positive, which would tip the totals toward positive.

By product (22 reviews each):

Product	Pos	Neg	Mixed	Neutral
Trailmark Hiking Backpack	10	8	1	3
Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	9	7	3	3
Hearth Electric Kettle	8	8	3	3
Breeze Wireless Earbuds	7	8	4	3
Lumen Smart Bulbs	7	9	3	3

The Backpack and Throw Blanket lean slightly positive. The Earbuds and Smart Bulbs lean slightly negative. Praise is mostly about value, comfort and sound for the price. Complaints are mostly about durability (things breaking within weeks), the Lumen app and connectivity, and listings that overstate the product.

Some judgment calls moved the counts by a few reviews. I counted shipping-only complaints as negative and “pretty but impractical” as negative. A review that praised the product but griped about packaging counted as positive. If you’d like, I can export the labels as a CSV or run this a different way, such as a strict positive/negative split.

Prompt 2:

You're a customer support professional.

Are these reviews positive or negative?

Label them only "Positive" or "Negative", if unsure pick the best option.

Response 2:

review_id,label

R001,Negative

R002,Positive

R003,Negative

R004,Negative

R005,Negative

R006,Positive

R007,Positive

R008,Negative

R009,Positive

R010,Positive

R011,Negative

R012,Positive

R013,Positive

R014,Positive

R015,Negative

Prompt 3:

Are these reviews positive or negative?

Your output should contain the columns: review number, product, sentiment, summary.

In the summary column, summarize the review with the fewest possible words.

If you're uncertain, write "uncertain" in the sentiment column. In the summary column for that review explain why you're uncertain in the fewest amount of words.

Response 3:

Review	Product	Sentiment	Summary
R001	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Negative	Chemical smell
R002	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Uncertain	Mixed: not true ANC, good for gym
R003	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Negative	Died; support ignored
R004	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Negative	Straps painful; returning
R005	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Uncertain	Mixed: not warm, fine decor
R006	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Positive	Great commute earbuds
R007	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Positive	Decent value; not serious
R008	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Uncertain	Mixed: vibrant but disconnects
R009	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Uncertain	Mixed: great bulbs, bad app
R010	Hearth Electric Kettle	Positive	Durable; repurchased
R011	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Negative	Arrived stained
R012	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Uncertain	Question, no opinion
R013	Hearth Electric Kettle	Uncertain	Failed; replacement works so far
R014	Hearth Electric Kettle	Positive	Dented, fast replacement, fine
R015	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Negative	Too small

Spot-check Table

Review ID	Product	Review_Text	My Sentiment	Claude Sentiment
R013	Hearth Electric Kettle	Stopped turning on after 6 weeks. Customer service sent a replacement, which works so far.	**Negative**	**Positive**
R059	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Waterproof as advertised and stayed dry in a downpour. Wish the hip belt had more padding.	**Positive**	**Positive**
R099	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	The knit pattern snags on everything. Pretty but impractical.	**Negative**	**Negative**
R007	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	decent bag for the money, not for serious backpacking tho	**Positive**	**Negative**
R024	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	wow so smart, it forgot all my settings after an update. genius.	**Negative**	**Negative**
R055	Hearth Electric Kettle	Love the temperature presets for tea. The beep when it finishes is way too loud though.	**Positive**	**Positive**
R072	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Not as good as my AirPods but for a quarter of the price I can't complain.	**Positive**	**Positive**
R075	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Smaller than expected. Barely covers my lap. Very soft though.	**Negative**	**Negative**
R094	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Bought these as a gift for my brother. He hasn't opened them yet.	**Negative**	**Positive**
R098	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Nothing says "smart home" like having to unplug the router to turn on my lights.	**Negative**	**Negative**

Spot Check Prompt:

You are an expert customer feedback analyst who is also incredibly good at spotting sarcasm.

Are these reviews positive or negative?

You should use the following columns: Review_ID, Product, Sentiment.

Sentiment should only be positive or negative. Use your best judgement and leave none as "uncertain"

Here are some examples:

"I love how this product burns my hand everytime I touch it!" = Negative

"I hate how much I use this product!" = Positive

Analysis:

This was a very interesting exercise to determine the effects of different prompting techniques on an LLMs outputs! The techniques I applied were role prompting, few-shot prompting, output formatting, constraints, and defining the categories.

Role prompting was the technique that I found least effective, it didnt appear to have much effect on the response as seen in prompt 2, it simply labeled each review and didn't provide any extra insight. In fact, the original prompt was much more organized and gave more information.

Few-shot prompting was one that I found to be useful. In the spot-check table I included some reviews that contained sarcasm which worried me with this exercise. To counter that I used two examples of sarcasm and how they would be classified. I was satisfied with the effect this technique had on the response.

I also used output formatting which was another technique that was extremely effective. You can see in my second prompt that the data is unorganized, and not nicely sitting in a table. When provided a specific format in prompt 3, Claude responded with a much more organized table.

Constraints were briefly used in the second and third prompts. I used them to ensure that Claude would label everything. For the most part I was satisfied with this technique.

Finally, I defined the categories explicitly in prompt 2. Claude was able to label each review with "Positive" or "Negative" as I also informed it to make the best choice and make sure nothing is uncertain.

Overall, I didn't have any trouble getting Claude to label everything. It handled sarcastic reviews surprisingly well. As previously stated, output formatting was the most impactful technique.